Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Allergen Testing

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- Specific immunoglobulin E (IgE) in-vitro allergy testing (CPT code 86003***, CPT code 86008****), up to 20 allergen specific antibodies per year, **IS REIMBURSABLE** for any of the following conditions:
  - Asthma
  - Pruritus and dermatitis
  - Suspected allergen-induced chronic rhinitis
  - Suspected allergy to specific drugs
  - Suspected food allergy
  - Suspected insect venom allergy
  - Urticaria

- In-vitro testing for total serum IgE (CPT code 82785*) **IS REIMBURSABLE** for any of the following conditions:
  - Chest or joint paint
  - Coughing up of mucous plugs
  - Fatigue
  - Fever
  - Headaches
  - Hemoptysis
  - Moderate or severe asthma
  - Skin lesions
  - Unintentional weight loss
  - Wheezing

- The Antigen Leukocyte Antibody Test (ALCAT) (CPT code 83516) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** for any of the following conditions:
  - Adverse effect of other drugs, medicaments and biological substances
  - Allergy status, other than to drugs and biological substances
  - Anaphylactic reaction
  - Dermatitis due to ingested foods
  - Encounter for allergy testing

- In-vitro testing of allergen specific immunoglobulin G (IgG) or non-specific IgG, immunoglobulin A (IgA), immunoglobulin M (IgM), or immunoglobulin D (IgD) in the evaluation of suspected allergy (CPT code 82784, CPT code 82787, CPT code 86001**) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** for any of the following conditions:
  - Adverse effect of other drugs, medicaments and biological substances
  - Allergy status, other than to drugs and biological substances
  - Anaphylactic reaction
  - Encounter for allergy testing

- Basophil activation flow cytometry testing (BAT) for measuring hypersensitivity to allergens (CPT code 88184*^, CPT code 88185*^) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

- In-vitro allergen testing using bead-based epitope assays, for example, VeriMAP™ Peanut Dx–Bead–based Epitope Assay (CPT code 0165U*^^, CPT code 0178U*^^), **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

- In-vitro testing of allergen non-specific IgE that does not identify a specific allergen using qualitative multi-allergen screen (CPT code 86005***) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure Code	Code Description
82784	Gammaglobulin (immunoglobulin); IgA, IgD, IgG, IgM, each
82785*	Gammaglobulin (immunoglobulin); IgE
82787	Gammaglobulin (immunoglobulin); immunoglobulin subclasses (eg, IgG1, 2, 3, or 4), each
83516	Immunoassay for analyte other than infectious agent antibody or infectious agent antigen; qualitative or semiquantitative, multiple step method
86001**	Allergen specific IgG quantitative or semiquantitative, each allergen
86003***	Allergen specific IgE; quantitative or semiquantitative, crude allergen extract, each
86005***	Allergen specific IgE; qualitative, multiallergen screen (eg, disk, sponge, card)
86008****	Allergen specific IgE; quantitative or semiquantitative, recombinant or purified component, each
88184*^	Flow cytometry, cell surface, cytoplasmic, or nuclear marker, technical component only; first marker
88185*^	Flow cytometry, cell surface, cytoplasmic, or nuclear marker, technical component only; each additional marker
0165U*^^	Peanut allergen-specific quantitative assessment of multiple epitopes using enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay (ELISA), blood, individual epitope results and probability of peanut allergy Proprietary test: VeriMAP™ Peanut Dx – Bead-based Epitope Assay Lab/Manufacturer: AllerGenis™ Clinical Laboratory
0178U*^^	Peanut allergen-specific quantitative assessment of multiple epitopes using enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay (ELISA), blood, report of minimum eliciting exposure for a clinical reaction Proprietary test: VeriMAP™ Peanut Sensitivity - Bead Based Epitope Assay Lab/Manufacturer: AllerGenis™ Clinical Laboratory

Original Medicare Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs)

Contractor Name	Policy Title	Policy Number	Procedure Code
CGS Administrators, LLC	Flow Cytometry	L34037	88184 88185
CGS Administrators, LLC	RAST Type Tests	L34063	86001 86003 86005
First Coast Service Options, Inc.	Allergy Testing	L33261	82785 86001 86003 86005 86008 88184 88185 0165U 0178U
National Government Services, Inc.	RAST Type Tests	L33591	86001 86003 86005 86008
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	Allergy Testing	L34313	86003 86005
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	Lab: Flow Cytometry	L34215	88184 88185
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	Lab: Flow Cytometry	L36094	88184 88185
Novitas Solutions, Inc.	Allergy Testing	L36241	82785 86001 86003 86005 86008 0165U 0178U
Novitas Solutions, Inc.	Flow Cytometry	L35032	88184 88185
Palmetto GBA	Lab: Flow Cytometry	L34513	88184 88185
Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation	Allergy Testing	L36402	82785 86001 86003 86005 86008

* The payment criterion for 82785 applies to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to First Coast Service Options, Inc., Novitas Solutions, Inc., and Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation.

*** The payment criteria for 86001 apply to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to CGS Administrators, First Coast Service Options, Inc., LLC, National Government Services, Inc., Novitas Solutions, Inc., and Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation.*

**** The payment criteria for 86003 and 86005 apply to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to CGS Administrators, LLC, First Coast Service Options, Inc., National Government Services, Inc., Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC, Novitas Solutions, Inc., and Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation.*

*****The payment criterion for 86008 applies to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to First Coast Service Options, Inc., LLC, National Government Services, Inc., Novitas Solutions, Inc., and Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation.*

**^The payment criteria for 88184 and 88185 apply to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to CGS Administrators, LLC, First Coast Service Options, Inc., Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC, Novitas Solutions, Inc., and Palmetto GBA.*

**^^The payment criteria for 0165U and 0178U apply to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to First Coast Service Options, Inc., and Novitas Solutions, Inc.*

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